

If you are able to boot into Safe Mode, first perform a virus and spyware scan using a tool such as Norton AntiVirus and Spybot S&D. Uninstall any recently added software, and remove or roll back any updated device drivers. (To roll back device drivers, go to the Properties page of the device in Device Manager, select the Driver tab, and click Roll Back Driver). In XP, you can perform one additional step—running System Restore, as explained above for Windows ME.

Restart the computer normally and check if the problem recurs. If it is an intermittent problem, and occurs at random, you can note down the error number the next time it occurs, since you disabled Automatic Restart after a crash. Boot into Safe Mode and see if you get the same random error. If you do, then the problem is likely hardware-related. Resolve the issue by following the hardware troubleshooting steps explained below. If the error only occurs in normal mode, then it is likely a software problem. Follow the steps for software and device driver troubleshooting described below.

Look in Device Manager and troubleshoot any hardware device conflicts as explained in the *Troubleshooting Hardware Device Conflicts in Windows* section. You can remove or disable the device, or roll back its driver to a previous version.

If the BSOD is caused by a faulty program that crashes Windows at system startup, you can disable the software from starting up by using `msconfig.exe`. Type Start > Run, type in “`msconfig`” and press [Enter]. Select the Startup tab and disable any or all software you think may be the ones causing the problem. Better still, you could disable all the software in the list, enable them one at a time, and reboot the computer to identify the offending software.

If the BSOD is caused by faulty hardware, remove any recently added hardware—after switching off the PC, of course! If the BSOD still occurs, or there are no newly added hardware, test the RAM for errors by using a memory diagnostic program such as Windows Memory Diagnostic (<http://oca.microsoft.com/en/windiag.asp>). See the *Memory* section of this guide for further information. If the